We are not concerned with which strategy won against any particular opponent. What matters is which strategy accumulated the most 'money', summed over all its 15 pairings. 'Money' means simply 'points', awarded according to the following scheme: mutual cooperation, 3 points; temptation to defect, 5 points; punishment for mutual defection, 1 point (equivalent to a light fine in our earlier game); sucker's pay-off, o points (equivalent to a heavy fine in our earlier game).

		What you do	
		Cooperate	**Defect**
What I do	**Cooperate**	Fairly good **REWARD** for mutual cooperation **3 points**	Very bad **SUCKER'S PAY-OFF** **0 points**
	Defect	Very good **TEMPTATION** to defect **5 points**	Fairly bad **PUNISHMENT** for mutual defection **1 points**

Figure C. Axelrod's computer tournament: pay-offs to me from various outcomes

The maximum possible score that any strategy could achieve was 15,000 (200 rounds at 5 points per round, for each of 15 opponents). The minimum possible score was o. Needless to say, neither of these two extremes was realized. The most that a strategy can realistically hope to win in an average one of its 15 pairings cannot be much more than 600 points. This is what two players would each receive if they both consistently cooperated, scoring 3 points for each of the 200 rounds of the game. If one of them succumbed to the temptation to defect, it would very probably end up with fewer points than 600 because of retaliation by the other player (most of the submitted strategies had some kind of retaliatory behaviour built into them). We can use 600 as a kind of benchmark for a game, and express all scores as a percentage of this benchmark. On this scale it is theoretically possible to score up to 166 per cent (1,000 points), but in practice no strategy's average score exceeded 600.